

Sample paraphrase

Food for a community

Milpa Alta, an area including twelve villages and towns situated to the south of Mexico city, puts significance on a community meal that is one of the most popular traditional events of that region. This event, known famously as “La Rejunta” takes place every Christmas. More appropriately, this meal can be considered as a feast since it involves about sixty thousand tamales and fifteen thousand litres of hot chocolate. Tamales are prepared from corns which are widely found in Milpa Alta, aligning with the meaning of the name of this village, ‘High Cornfield’.

This ceremony, regarded as an important religious event, is attended by around 20,000 people and arranged for people who go on the long walk to “El Señor de Chalma”.

For La Rejunta, preparations are done throughout the year. Each year the “majordomos” are selected to organize the meal. The current waiting list made for choosing majordomos is unavailable until 2046. Virginia Meza Torres and her spouse Fermin Lara Jimenez are the majordomos for this year who filled in their name in the list fourteen years ago.

A year before this celebration, men go to forests to gather wood and store them near the home of the majordomos. Mandatorily, the wood needs to be dry. In terms of ingredients, corn, meat and vegetables grown by local peasants are used and instant or ready-made foods are prohibited. Everyone, wonderfully being aware of their duties, cooks together all night long. The Fermin ensures the sufficiency of tamales for everyone.

Eating together, being a crucial tradition of this area, is compared as “a glue that keeps people together” by Josefina Garcia Jimenez. According to her, it is like “passing down a tradition” and being remembered. She emphasizes on the time spent together because of this event and the love it shows to the children of the community. Moreover, the time spent at the table following the dinner by the family members is significant too since they all share their thoughts and stories and enjoy them together. Therefore, at Christmas, La Rejunta plays the role of a massive/huge family meal.

(Original text: <https://www.ngllife.com/communal-table-0>)